

Communication Skills and Computer Applications



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Buying a computer:

decipher the
minefield

Pick Your Operating System



Windows

- best choice if you need Microsoft apps like MS Office, Access, or Outlook



MacOS

- tightly coupled with the company's hardware



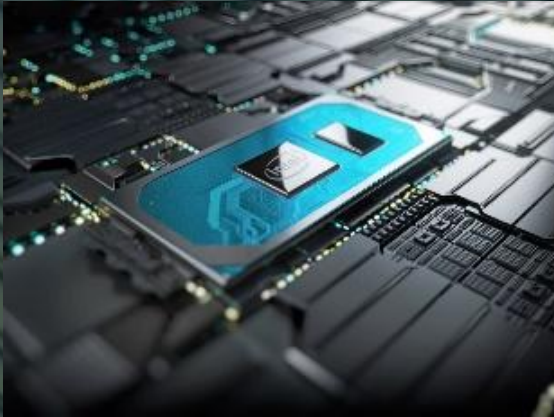
Chromebooks

- If you can do most of your laptop tasks in a web browser



Linux

- install free Linux versions on just about any piece of laptop hardware ever created



Pick Your CPU

The “chip” or “the CPU”

- number of cores
- speed (GHz) of the processor

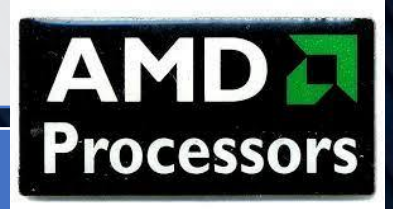
Intel

- best performance when it comes to multitasking and multimedia
- Core i3 in entry-level systems
- Core i9 is the most powerful



AMD

- Equivalent power to Intel





How much RAM?

Short term memory

- what your laptop uses to hold data while the processor does things with it.

The more the merrier

- DDR4 RAM “double data rate” = faster

Is it part of the motherboard?

- If no expansion slots = can't add more



Which hard drive?

Long term memory

- where your laptop stores data.

The more the merrier

- Usually “SSD”
- An SSD drive will outperform HDD drives. Ideally minimum 256__
- Less needed if storing on the Cloud

What Ports?
- check there
are ones!

Firewire



HDMI



USB



Use Resources to Research Specs

ChatGPT ▾



what would be a computer specification for a student completing a BSc in Forestry for the next 4 years. No very heavy graphics. Mainly MS office suite, internet and GIS package

For a **BSc Forestry student** planning to use a computer over the next 4 years, the system should be **reliable, portable, and capable of handling moderate GIS workloads** (like QGIS or ArcGIS), along with everyday academic tasks (MS Office, web browsing, reports, and presentations).

Here's a well-balanced specification:

✅ **Recommended Laptop Specifications (2025–2029)**

under €1000

on tasks like MS Office, internet browsing, and GIS
under €1,000 should offer a balance of performance, portability,
specifications that meet these criteria:



Use Resources to Research Specs



Use Resources to Research pre-used



refurburished laptop



Feel free to ask me for
advice